THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A historian relies only on the Prayaga Prashasti for Samudragupta. The major risk is 1

(a) too little detail **(b)** one-sided praise from a court poet
(c) no names **(d)** too many dates

2. Which statement correctly contrasts Mauryan and Gupta administration? 1

(a) no difference
(b) Mauryas used land grants
(c) Guptas had no kings
(d) Guptas relied more on feudatories and land grants

3. Why might Gupta gold coins show kings playing musical instruments? 1

(a) to show tax **(b)** to show war
(c) to display cultural refinement **(d)** to show farms

4. Faxian says the people of the Gangetic plains were prosperous but also mentions chandalas outside the city. This shows 1

(a) prosperity and social inequality existed together
(b) equality
(c) no towns
(d) no trade

5. If land grants were made to temples, the likely effect was 1

(a) end of temples
(b) spread of agriculture and rise of temple economy
(c) drop in trade
(d) end of farming

6. What is the main difference between a prashasti and a traveller's account? 1

(a) one is by a court poet, the other by an outsider
(b) one is a map and the other a coin
(c) one is modern
(d) both are coins

7. The presence of Roman and Chinese goods in Gupta cities suggests 1

(a) no trade **(b)** isolation
(c) wide trade contacts **(d)** war

8. Which of these is a historical evidence for science in the Gupta age? 1

(a) Aryabhatiya **(b)** Silappadikaram **(c)** Arthashastra **(d)** Indica

9. **Assertion (A):** The Iron Pillar of Delhi has not rusted for centuries. 1
Reason (R): A thin protective layer forms on the surface of the pillar.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Prayaga Prashasti praises Samudragupta. 1
Reason (R): It was composed by Harisena, his court poet.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why are prashastis not entirely reliable? 2

12. Why did regional kingdoms rise at the end? 2

13. What does land grant tell us about society? 2

14. How do foreign accounts supplement Indian sources? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the Gupta age as a 'Golden Age'. 3

16. Examine the role of religion in Gupta politics. 3

17. Examine the evidence for social divisions in Gupta times. 3

OR

Analyse how foreign accounts and inscriptions complement each other. 3

18. Evaluate the position of women in the Gupta period. 3

OR

Assess the importance of Nalanda for Asian learning. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Faxian, a Chinese Buddhist monk, travelled to India in the early 5th century CE to visit holy sites and collect Buddhist texts. He wrote an account of his journey, describing the kingdoms he saw and the monasteries where he stayed. 5
(i) Which country did Faxian come from?
(ii) Why did he travel to India?
(iii) During whose reign did he visit?
(iv) Why should a historian compare Faxian's account with other sources?

20. Evaluate the achievements of the Gupta age in science, literature and arts. 5

OR

Discuss the regional kingdoms such as the Vakatakas, Pallavas and Kamarupa and their relation with the Guptas. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks